

■ PAWN

AI Agent Business Operations Guide

Everything you need to launch, price, and operate an AI agent side gig — voice, chat, email, and reputation management for small businesses.

4

AI Agents covered

6

Bundle options

\$0–\$400/mo

Your platform costs

100%

Remote setup

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SECTION 1

Business Overview — What Pawn Does

Pawn is an AI agent side business that deploys and manages specialized AI agents for small businesses. You act as the operator — you source the platforms, configure the agents, train them on each client's content, and provide ongoing support — while charging clients a monthly retainer for the service.

The core value proposition is straightforward: small businesses pay \$8–12 per human-handled call, spend 28% of their week on email, miss 62% of inbound calls after hours, and often have no system for managing their online reputation. Pawn solves all four problems with AI agents that cost a fraction of the alternative — and you build the business on the margin between platform costs and your client fees.

Target clients

- Service businesses — plumbers, HVAC, electricians, roofers, landscapers
- Medical and dental offices — appointment-heavy, high call volume
- Law offices and financial advisors — email-intensive, reputation-sensitive
- Restaurants and hospitality — reviews matter enormously
- Salons, spas, and fitness studios — booking and reputation focused
- Real estate agents — lead capture and fast response critical

Key insight

San Diego alone has tens of thousands of small service businesses. A 10-client book generates \$5,000+/month recurring — with roughly 15–20 hours of ongoing work.

SECTION 2

The Four AI Agents

■■ Voice Agent

Phone call handling

Your AI receptionist answers every inbound call instantly — in a natural, professional voice — 24/7 including weekends and after hours. It conducts full conversations, not just menu trees.

- Answers and qualifies every inbound call in real time
- Books appointments directly into the client's calendar
- Handles FAQs, hours, pricing, directions, and service questions
- Transfers complex calls to a human with full context summary
- Sends instant SMS summaries to the business owner after each call
- Operates in 60+ languages
- Integrates with Google Calendar, Calendly, and most CRMs

Platform	Retell AI — \$0.07/min, no platform fee
Key stat	Avg. human agent costs \$8–12/call. AI: under \$0.50/call.

■ Website Chatbot

Live website chat

A smart chat widget embedded on the client's website that engages visitors the moment they land — answering questions, capturing leads, and booking appointments without any human involvement.

- Answers product, pricing, and service questions instantly
- Collects lead name, email, and phone — syncs to CRM
- Books appointments and sends confirmation emails
- Proactively engages visitors who linger on pricing or contact pages
- Trained on client's actual content — website, docs, FAQs
- Works across mobile and desktop seamlessly

- Deploys via a single line of code on any website

Platform	Chatbase — from \$32/mo
Key stat	62% of visitors leave without a response. AI captures them.

✉ Email Agent

Inbox automation

Reads every incoming email, classifies it, drafts a reply in the client's voice, and sends it — or escalates with a one-line summary when judgment is needed. Typical response time: under 2 minutes.

- Reads, triages, and categorizes every incoming email
- Drafts and sends replies in the client's brand voice
- Handles quote requests, scheduling, and follow-up emails
- Syncs natively with Gmail and Outlook via OAuth
- Escalates complex emails with a concise summary to the owner
- Logs all interactions to the client's CRM automatically
- Handles high volume without any human bottleneck

Platform	Lindy — from \$49.99/mo
Key stat	Average business spends 28% of their week on email.

■ Reputation Agent

Reviews & feedback management

Monitors reviews across Google, Yelp, and Facebook — responding to feedback, flagging issues, and automatically prompting happy customers to leave a review while the experience is still fresh.

- Monitors Google Business, Yelp, Facebook, and TripAdvisor 24/7
- Drafts and sends personalized responses to every review
- Sends automated review request texts after a completed job
- Instant alert to owner for any review under 4 stars
- Tracks average rating trends across all platforms over time
- Identifies recurring complaints before they become patterns

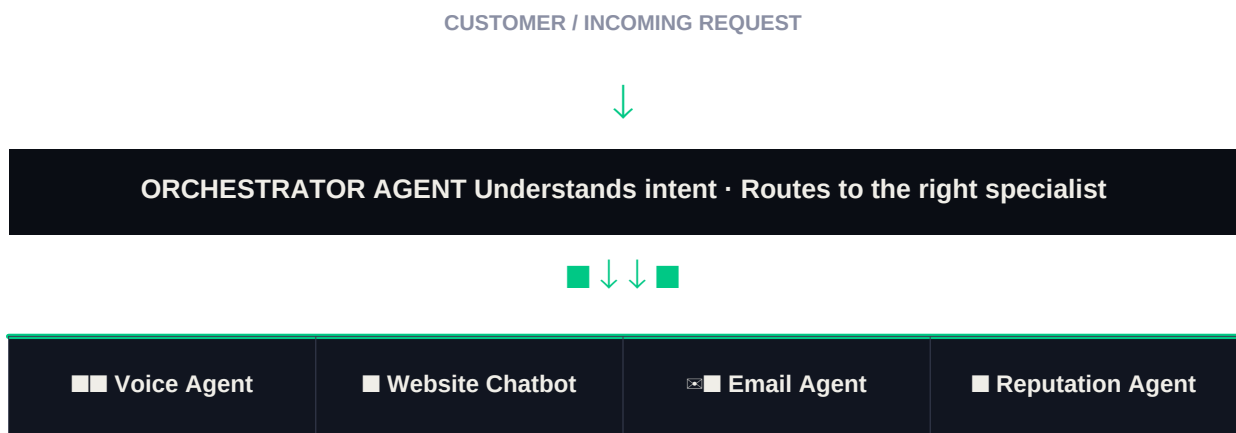
- Monthly reputation report delivered to the client

Platform	Lindy + n8n + Twilio — from \$15/mo
Key stat	Businesses with 4.5+ stars earn 28% more revenue on average.

SECTION 3

Multi-Agent Architecture

The most production-ready architecture in 2026 is the orchestrator + subagent (hub-and-spoke) model, used by approximately 70% of production deployments. One master 'orchestrator' agent sits at the top of the chain, understands the incoming intent, and routes it to the appropriate specialist agent. All coordination flows through the orchestrator — workers don't talk to each other.



- The orchestrator is the 'brain' — it never does the actual task, it only understands and delegates.
- Subagents are specialists — each has one job, its own set of tools, and its own integrations.
- All results return to the orchestrator, which logs and confirms the completed action.
- This architecture makes debugging clean and gives you a single point of control per client.
- You can build this on MindStudio (no-code), n8n (low-code), or CrewAI (Python).

SECTION 4

Platform & Tools You'll Need

Every tool below is accessed remotely from your laptop. No servers to manage, no hardware to buy. Most have free tiers to test before committing.

Voice Agent Platform

Tool	Cost	Notes
Retell AI	\$0.07/min	Best overall. Sub-600ms latency, no platform fee, SOC 2 compliant. Supports bring-your-own LLM. 30M+ calls/month.
Thoughtly	Usage-based	Easiest for first deployments. Great UI, fast setup, good for clients new to AI voice.
Bland AI / Vapi	~\$0.05–0.33/min	Developer-friendly. Headline rate is low but real production cost is higher — factor this in.

Website Chatbot Platform

Tool	Cost	Notes
Chatbase	\$32–\$89/mo	Best for resellers. Train on any content, white-label capable, no-code, fast setup.
Tidio	Free–\$49/mo	Best for e-commerce clients. Blends live chat with AI.
Boei	€14/mo flat	Best value. 50+ channel integrations, 2,000 AI messages included, no per-seat fees.

Email Agent Platform

Tool	Cost	Notes
Lindy	\$49.99–\$99/mo	Best all-around. Sends from client's actual Gmail/Outlook, CRM sync, multi-step workflows.
Fyxr	\$25–\$40/mo	Best for inbox triage + drafting. Server-side, works even when inbox is closed.

Tool	Cost	Notes
Carly	\$35/mo	Best for fully autonomous email handling. Responds, schedules, logs — minimal human touchpoints.

Reputation Agent

Tool	Cost	Notes
Lindy + n8n + Twilio	\$15–\$40/mo	Best DIY stack. Connect Google Business API, Yelp, Facebook. Twilio for SMS review requests.
SaneBox	~\$7/mo	Add-on for email triage. Pairs well with a reputation workflow.

Orchestration / Workflow Glue

Tool	Cost	Notes
MindStudio	Free–\$15/mo	No-code. 1,000+ integrations, pre-built agent templates. Best starting point.
n8n (self-hosted)	~\$0–\$20/mo	Open-source. Most flexible, lowest cost at scale. Requires more technical setup.
CrewAI	Free (open-source)	Python-based multi-agent framework. Best for building custom, scalable agent systems.

Telephony

Tool	Cost	Notes
Twilio	\$1–5/mo per number + usage	Industry standard. Phone number provisioning, SMS, call routing. Pairs with Retell AI.

Business Operations

Tool	Cost	Notes
Zoom / Google Meet	Free	Client intake calls, onboarding sessions, screen sharing.
Loom	Free	Record setup walkthrough videos to send clients.
Stripe	Free + 2.9%/txn	Client invoicing and recurring billing.

Tool	Cost	Notes
Typeform / Google Forms	Free	Client intake questionnaires.
Notion / Google Sheets	Free	Client tracking, notes, SOPs.

SECTION 5

Pricing — What You Charge Clients

Every bundle includes setup, training on client content, integrations, and ongoing support. Month-to-month, no contracts.

Bundle	Monthly Fee	Setup Fee	What's Included
Voice Only	\$299/mo	\$399	Voice agent, calendar booking, call summaries, monthly report, 500 min/mo
Chatbot Only	\$199/mo	\$299	Website chat widget, lead capture, CRM sync, appointment booking, monthly report
Email Only	\$249/mo	\$299	Gmail/Outlook integration, auto-triage, auto-reply, CRM logging, escalation
Reviews Only	\$179/mo	\$249	Google/Yelp/Facebook monitoring, review responses, SMS review requests, monthly report
Voice + Chat	\$449/mo	\$599	Voice + chatbot, shared CRM/calendar, combined reporting, priority support
Chat + Email	\$399/mo	\$499	Chatbot + email, unified lead tracking, CRM sync, priority support
Full Stack	\$749/mo	\$999	All four agents, orchestrator routing, full CRM + calendar, brand voice training, dedicated AM

Tip

Lead with the Full Stack bundle. Most clients don't know which agents they need — presenting 'all four for \$749' is simpler to sell than four separate products, and your margin is best.

SECTION 6

Your Costs to Run Each Agent

These are your actual platform costs per client per month. Everything below assumes a typical small business (300 calls/mo, 400 emails/mo, moderate review volume).

Voice Agent cost breakdown

Platform: Retell AI at \$0.07/min. At 300 calls averaging 5 minutes each: $300 \times 5 \times \$0.07 = \$105/\text{mo}$. Add Twilio phone number (\$2–5/mo). Total: roughly \$40–\$180/mo depending on volume.

Agent	Volume Assumption	Your Platform Cost	Client Charge	Gross Margin/mo
Voice Agent	300 calls/mo	\$40–\$180/mo	\$299/mo	\$120–\$260/mo
Website Chatbot	Std. volume	\$32–\$89/mo	\$199/mo	\$110–\$167/mo
Email Agent	400 emails/mo	\$49–\$99/mo	\$249/mo	\$150–\$200/mo
Reputation Agent	Moderate	\$15–\$40/mo	\$179/mo	\$139–\$164/mo
Full Stack (all)	Combined	\$150–\$400/mo	\$749/mo	\$349–\$599/mo

Additional cost factors

- Twilio SMS (for review requests and call summaries): ~\$0.0075/SMS — negligible at small business volume
- Your time for initial setup: 5–10 hours per client (covered by setup fees)
- Monthly maintenance per client: ~1–2 hours of light tuning and report review
- Orchestration platform (MindStudio/n8n): \$0–\$20/mo total, shared across all clients
- Watch for overage charges on voice if a client's call volume spikes — build overages into your contract

SECTION 7

Profit & Margin Analysis

Revenue at different client counts (Full Stack only)

Clients	Gross Revenue	Platform Costs	Net Profit	Annual Net
5 clients	\$3,745/mo	~\$1,000/mo	~\$2,745/mo	~\$33,000/yr
10 clients	\$7,490/mo	~\$2,200/mo	~\$5,290/mo	~\$63,000/yr
15 clients	\$11,235/mo	~\$3,500/mo	~\$7,735/mo	~\$93,000/yr
20 clients	\$14,980/mo	~\$4,800/mo	~\$10,180/mo	~\$122,000/yr

At 10 Full Stack clients you're at \$5,000+/month net with roughly 15–20 hours of work. Setup fees (\$999 each) add \$9,990 in one-time income during onboarding. Mixed bundles (some clients on smaller plans) will shift these numbers slightly.

Time commitment

Once a client is live, expect 1–2 hours/month per client for maintenance, reporting, and support. The intake and setup phase is the heaviest at 5–10 hours per new client.

SECTION 8

Remote Setup — How It Works

Every agent is configured entirely from your laptop. You never need to visit a client's office, touch their computer, or access their password. Here's exactly how each agent gets set up remotely.

■■ Voice Agent

1. You create the Retell AI account and build the agent on your end.
2. Provision a phone number via Twilio (~2 minutes).
3. Client forwards their existing business number to the new AI number via their carrier's online portal — takes 3 minutes.
4. Alternatively, the new number can be a secondary line clients share with customers.
5. Their existing number stays the same. Calls route through the AI first.

■ Website Chatbot

1. Build and train the agent on Chatbase using the client's website content, docs, and FAQ.
2. Generate a single embed script tag from the Chatbase dashboard (one line of code).
3. Client (or their web person) pastes the tag into their website's custom code section.
4. Works on Wix, Squarespace, WordPress, Shopify — any platform with a custom HTML field.
5. You can do this yourself over a screen share in under 5 minutes.

✉ ■ Email Agent

1. You build the Lindy workflow — email triage rules, reply templates, escalation logic — on your end.
2. Client clicks 'Sign in with Google' or 'Connect Outlook' — a standard OAuth permission pop-up.
3. They click Allow. You never see their password. It's the same flow as any 'Sign in with Google' button.
4. Agent is live immediately. All replies come from their actual email address.

■ Reputation Agent

1. Connect to their Google Business Profile via Google Business API — they grant access through a standard Google permissions screen.
2. Same for Facebook Business — standard OAuth grant.
3. Yelp connection via Yelp Fusion API (or monitoring via n8n scraping workflow).
4. Twilio SMS setup for review request texts — you configure templates with their business name.
5. Alert notifications go to their phone number or email of choice.

What the client needs to do (total)

Task	Time Required	How
Click Allow on Google/Outlook OAuth	30 seconds	Standard permission pop-up — like any app login
Paste one script tag on website	3–5 minutes	Screen share with you, or hand to web person
Set up call forwarding	3–5 minutes	Settings page on their phone carrier's website

SECTION 9

Client Onboarding Workflow

Day 1 — Intake call (30–45 min via Zoom)

- Ask about their services, pricing, hours, FAQs, and tone of voice.
- Find out how most customers currently reach them (call, email, walk-in).
- Identify their biggest pain point — missed calls, slow email responses, bad reviews.
- Record the call. This is your training data for the agents.
- Send them an intake form afterward to fill in any gaps (use Typeform or Google Forms).

Day 1–2 — You build (5–10 hours)

- Configure all agent platforms with the client's info.
- Train the chatbot on their website content and uploaded docs.
- Write the voice agent script — FAQs, fallback responses, escalation triggers.
- Set up email templates and escalation rules in Lindy.
- Build the reputation monitoring workflow and SMS templates.
- Test every agent yourself: make test calls, send test chats, trigger test emails.

Day 2–3 — Onboarding call (30–45 min via Zoom)

- Screen share and walk them through granting OAuth permissions (5 min).
- Paste the chat widget code on their site together (5 min).
- Walk through call forwarding setup on their carrier portal (5 min).
- Do a live demo: call the number, chat on the site, send a test email.
- Show them the reporting dashboard and what they'll receive monthly.

Day 3 — Go live

- Flip the switch on all agents.
- Monitor closely for the first 48 hours — check logs, make small adjustments.
- Send the client a 'you're live' summary email with what to expect.

Ongoing — Monthly maintenance (1–2 hrs/client)

- Review the monthly performance logs — calls handled, emails resolved, review responses sent.
- Update FAQs and agent responses based on new questions that came in.

- Send the client their monthly performance report.
- Handle any integration issues (calendar sync glitches, new Outlook changes, etc.).
- Quarterly: strategy call to review results and discuss expanding their bundle.

SECTION 10

Business Intelligence & Insights

Every interaction your agents handle generates data. Pawn captures, stores, and analyzes this data to deliver real business intelligence to your clients — and to help you improve the agents over time.

Peak hour tracking

Every call, chat, and email is timestamped. You can show clients exactly when their busiest hours are — so they can staff smarter, plan promotions, and ensure the right human is available during genuine peaks.

Common question discovery

Agents track the most frequently asked questions, complaints, and requests across every channel. When 40 people ask about weekend hours in a month, you flag it to the client — so they update their website, their FAQs, or their actual offering.

Lead source analysis

Are the best leads coming from calls, chat, or email? Pawn tracks lead quality and conversion across all agents so clients know where to invest their marketing budget.

Full transcript storage

Every call is transcribed, every chat logged, every email thread stored — organized by date, topic, and outcome. Searchable in seconds if a client ever needs to reference a conversation.

Monthly intelligence reports

No dashboards to learn. Every month, clients receive a plain-English summary of what happened, what's trending, and what the agents recommend changing. Delivered to their inbox automatically.

Recurring complaint detection

If the same complaint appears 5+ times in a month, the reputation agent flags it as a pattern — not just a one-off. This gives clients actionable operational feedback, not just review scores.

SECTION 11

Reputation Management Deep Dive

The reputation agent is your highest-margin product (\$139–\$164/mo gross per client) and one of the easiest sells — every business owner understands the value of a 5-star rating.

Platforms monitored

Platform	Access Method	What the Agent Does
Google Business	Google Business API (OAuth)	Monitors new reviews, drafts responses, sends for approval or auto-posts
Yelp	Yelp Fusion API	Monitors new reviews, flags to owner, drafts responses
Facebook	Facebook Graph API (OAuth)	Monitors page reviews and recommendations
TripAdvisor	n8n monitoring workflow	Alerts on new reviews — response done manually or via email

Review request flow (the biggest revenue driver)

Most 5-star reviews are never left — not because the customer wasn't happy, but because no one asked. The reputation agent solves this with a timed SMS after every completed job:

1. Job completed → agent detects completion via calendar event or CRM update
2. Wait 2–4 hours (while the positive experience is still fresh)
3. Send SMS: 'Hi [Name], thanks for choosing [Business]! If you had a great experience, we'd love a quick Google review: [link]'
4. If no review in 48 hours → optional gentle follow-up SMS
5. Review posted → agent responds within minutes with a personalized thank-you

Negative review handling

- Any review under 4 stars triggers an instant alert to the business owner via SMS and email.
- Alert includes the full review text, the platform, and the reviewer's name.
- The agent drafts a professional response acknowledging the issue — owner approves before posting.
- For repeat complaints, the agent flags the pattern in the monthly report.

- Response time under 10 minutes significantly improves how the review looks to other customers.

SECTION 12

Scaling the Business

Phase 1 — First 3 clients (Month 1–2)

- Offer 1 free month to your first 2–3 clients in exchange for a testimonial and referral.
- Focus on one vertical (e.g. plumbers, salons, or medical offices) — easier to build templates.
- Refine your intake form and onboarding checklist so the process becomes faster each time.
- Aim to get setup time from 10 hours down to 5 hours by client 3.

Phase 2 — Systematize (Month 3–6)

- Build reusable agent templates per industry — one for plumbers, one for medical, one for legal.
- Create a client portal (Notion or a simple dashboard) where they can see their monthly stats.
- Hire a VA (\$5–15/hr) to handle monthly report generation and light client communication.
- Target referrals: offer existing clients \$100/mo off for every referral that converts.

Phase 3 — Growth (Month 6+)

- Consider white-labeling the Pawn brand so larger agencies can resell your agent service.
 - Add vertical-specific add-ons (e.g. HIPAA-compliant voice for medical, multilingual for hospitality).
 - Explore partnerships with web designers and marketing agencies who serve small businesses.
 - At 20+ clients, consider hiring a part-time technical assistant for setup and maintenance.
-

Summary — Quick Reference

Item	Detail
Agents offered	Voice, Website Chat, Email, Reputation (4 total)
Setup method	100% remote — Zoom + OAuth + one script tag
Setup time per client	5–10 hours (yours), ~15 min Zoom (theirs)
Monthly client work	1–2 hours per client for maintenance

Item	Detail
Platform costs (Full Stack)	\$150–\$400/mo per client
Client charge (Full Stack)	\$749/mo + \$999 setup
Gross margin (Full Stack)	\$349–\$599/mo per client
10 clients net (annual)	~\$63,000/yr
Best starting platform	Retell AI (voice) + Chatbase (chat) + Lindy (email + reputation)
Orchestration	MindStudio (no-code) or n8n (low-code)
Invoicing	Stripe — recurring monthly billing
First clients	Friends, family, local San Diego service businesses

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